



Project Controls Institute Global, Inc.

"AI proposes. The professional disposes."

Marketing Playbook

Channels, LinkedIn outreach & the complete
ready-to-send template library

Prepared for the PCI marketing team

August 2026 · Internal working document

Companion asset: LinkedIn Launch Pack (20 posts)

*Voice rule: teach, don't hype — never claim accreditation, recognition or outcomes
PCI does not yet hold. Honesty is the brand.*

projectcontrolsinstitute.org · hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

Contents

Part 1 — The facts to memorise	2
Part 2 — Techniques per platform	3
2.1 LinkedIn — the priority channel	3
2.2 X / Twitter	4
2.3 YouTube	4
2.4 Instagram	4
2.5 WhatsApp & Telegram	4
2.6 Facebook & Reddit	4
2.7 Email	4
2.8 The website itself	4
2.9 Partners	4
Part 3 — The template library	5
3.A LinkedIn templates	5
3.B WhatsApp / short text templates	6
3.C Email templates	7
3.D Post templates (LinkedIn / newsletter)	10
3.E Quick replies to common questions	11
Part 4 — Do / Don't (the guardrails)	11

A practical working document for PCI marketing. Part 1 gives you the facts to memorise, Part 2 the techniques per platform (LinkedIn is the priority), Part 3 the message templates — short to long, copy-paste ready, just personalise the [brackets].

Three golden rules (apply to every message and post):

1. **Stay honest.** Never claim accreditation, guaranteed jobs/salary, or 501(c)(3) status. PCI's candour *is* the brand. (Quick do/don't list in Part 4.)
2. **Personalise the first line.** One sentence showing you know who they are beats any template.
3. **One message, one ask.** Visit the site, apply, reply, or book a call — never all four.

Part 1 — The facts to memorise

Question you'll get	Answer
What is PCI?	The Project Controls Institute — an independent, non-profit certifying body for project controls, cost engineering and project finance, with governed AI built into the standard. Founded 2025. Slogan: <i>"AI proposes. The professional disposes."</i>
What does it offer?	Three professional certifications — PCL-AI (AI Project Controls Leader), PFL-AI (AI Project Finance Leader), PML-AI (Project Management Leader – AI) — plus membership, a global chapter network (20+ countries), free resources, webinars and a community.
Is it accredited?	Its framework is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 ; PCI is building toward formal accreditation and says so plainly — it does not claim accreditation it doesn't hold.
How are exams run?	Real, proctored, scenario-based exams delivered through a locked-down secure exam client. Preparation is on Certuvo , PCI's official study platform.
Can credentials be checked?	Yes — every credential and honorary award is publicly verifiable at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html , any time, by anyone.
Ways in?	Standard (paid, exam) · Founding (free during the founding window, exam still required) · Honorary (free, no exam — board-conferred Honorary Fellow (PCI) for distinguished contribution).
What does honorary cost?	Nothing. Ever. No application fee, no conferral fee, no membership fee, no renewal fee.
What do Honorary Fellows get?	A registered, verifiable PCI-HON award number + certificate PDF, free access to PCI resources (downloads, reports, body of knowledge), webinars and events, the chapter community, and careers/directory visibility as those surfaces roll out. It is recognition of contribution — always labelled honorary, never the examined certification.
What does the standard route cost?	Current published pricing (check the live membership page before quoting): membership USD 99 per 3-year term, PCL-AI exam USD 500 — launch discounts currently applied (≈ USD 49.50 and USD 350).
Key links	Site: projectcontrolsinstitute.org · Apply (honorary): /honorary-application.html · Enrol: /enrol.html · Verify: /verify.html · Contact: hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org
Social	LinkedIn: linkedin.com/company/project-control-institute · X: @projectcontrolinstitute

Part 2 — Techniques per platform

2.1 LinkedIn — the priority channel

This is where project controls professionals, cost engineers, planners and their employers live. Put 70% of the effort here.

A. Set the foundations (week 1)

1. Complete the company page: banner, about section (use the Part 1 facts), website link, and the "Enrol" custom button.
2. Optimise the personal profile of whoever does outreach: headline mentioning PCI, an About section with the one-liner, the site in the Featured section. People reply to people, not logos.
3. Follow and turn on notifications for the top 30 voices in project controls / cost engineering / planning — their comment sections are your audience.

B. Post consistently (every week)

- **Cadence:** 3–4 posts a week from the company page. The ready-made pack in docs/marketing/linkedin-launch-20-posts.md covers the first 5–6 weeks.
- **Formats that work, in order:** short text post with one strong image → document/carousel (e.g. "5 signs your CPI is lying", certificate visuals) → poll (great early reach) → short video.
- **Structure every post:** hook line first (the only line people see before "...see more"), teach one concrete thing, one soft CTA, 3–5 hashtags (#ProjectControls #CostEngineering #PlanningEngineer #EarnedValue #ProjectManagement).
- **Announcements are your best content:** every honorary conferral and every newly earned credential is a post — name (with permission), citation, award number, verify link, tag the person. Tagged posts reach their whole network.

C. Engage daily (15 minutes)

- Comment something substantive on 3–5 industry posts every day — comments from the personal profile, replies from the page. This is free distribution.
- Reply to every comment on PCI posts within 24 hours.

D. Connect and DM (the outreach engine — templates in Part 3)

- 20–30 targeted connection requests per week: planners, cost engineers, project controls managers/directors, PMO leads — prioritise the chapter countries (Gulf, UK, US, India, Pakistan, Australia...).
- Sequence: **connection note** (≤300 characters) → after acceptance, **thank-you + short intro DM** → if they engage, the **detailed DM** or an email. Never pitch in the connection note itself, never send the long message first, and stop after one polite follow-up — no spam.
- For distinguished senior figures, use the **honorary invitation** track instead — it opens far more doors than a sales message, because you're offering recognition, not asking for money.

E. Use LinkedIn's free extras

- **LinkedIn Events** for every webinar (attendees get reminders; the event page markets itself).
- **Company newsletter** once the page has some followers — monthly digest, same content as the email newsletter.
- **Polls** monthly ("Which forecast formula does your project trust?") — cheap reach + content ideas from the results.

F. Measure weekly: follower growth, engagement rate per post, DM reply rate, link clicks (use UTM tags: ?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=dm), honorary applications started.

2.2 X / Twitter

Repurpose every LinkedIn post as a short thread the same day. Follow and reply to construction, energy and mega-project commentary. Low effort, keeps the handle alive.

2.3 YouTube

Record every webinar → publish full version + 2–3 one-minute clips (Shorts) with a worked example each. Video titles = search phrases ("What is Earned Value Management?", "Project controls career path").

2.4 Instagram

Visual-only repurposing: quote cards from posts, certificate/badge visuals, chapter photos, 30-second explainer reels. Bio link to the site. Two posts a week is enough.

2.5 WhatsApp & Telegram

Project controls communities in the Gulf, India and Pakistan run on WhatsApp/Telegram groups. Join relevant professional groups, contribute genuinely, and share the short template (3.B) when someone asks about certifications — never cold-blast a group. A PCI-run broadcast channel for exam windows and webinar dates works well once there's an audience.

2.6 Facebook & Reddit

Facebook groups for planning engineers and Reddit (r/projectmanagement, r/ConstructionManagers) allow discussion, not ads. Answer questions helpfully; mention PCI only where it genuinely answers the question, and disclose you work with PCI. One good answer outperforms ten promo posts.

2.7 Email

- **Newsletter** (signup is on every page of the site): monthly — one teaching piece, one platform update, exam windows, new conferrals.
- **Direct outreach:** templates 3.C — short first, detail on reply. Always a real person's name, always an unsubscribe line for lists.

2.8 The website itself

- Point regional/paid traffic at the matching regional pages (e.g. /project-controls-certification-saudi-arabia.html), not the homepage.
- Keep the site-wide **announcement banner** (edited from the admin console, no developer needed) pointed at the current campaign.
- Publish the best-performing LinkedIn posts as blog articles for SEO.
- **Before any campaign: switch on analytics** — the site has a prepared Plausible/GA4 hook that ships disabled. Without it you can't measure anything.

2.9 Partners

Employers (/why-employers.html), universities (/university-partnerships.html) and training providers (/become-a-training-partner.html) each have a landing page and a template below. One warm partner intro is worth a month of cold DMs — and an honorary conferral to a respected figure inside a target organisation is the warmest intro there is.

Part 3 — The template library

Everything below is copy-paste ready. Personalise [brackets], keep the honesty language intact. Ordered short → long within each group.

3.A LinkedIn templates

A1. Connection note — general (≤300 characters)

Use when: connecting with any project controls professional.

Hi [Name] — I work with the Project Controls Institute, a new non-profit body building a certification standard for project controls in the AI era. Your work at [Company] caught my eye. Would be glad to connect.

A2. Connection note — senior figure / honorary prospect (≤300 characters)

Use when: connecting with a distinguished practitioner you may later invite to apply for Honorary Fellow.

Hi [Name] — I'm with the Project Controls Institute. Your contribution to [specific thing — book, standard, community, major programme] is exactly the kind of work our institute exists to recognise. I'd be glad to connect.

A3. First DM after they accept — short intro

Use when: they accepted; keep it light, no links yet unless natural.

Thanks for connecting, [Name]. Quick intro so this isn't a mystery: PCI is an independent non-profit institute certifying project controls, cost engineering and project finance — with the governed use of AI treated as part of the discipline. We're building it in the open, honest about status, everything publicly verifiable. If you're ever curious it's all at projectcontrolsinstitute.org — and I'm happy to answer anything. Either way, glad to have you in the network.

A4. DM — the platform explained (medium)

Use when: they replied, asked a question, or engaged with a post.

Happy to give you the full picture, [Name].

PCI (Project Controls Institute) is an independent, non-profit certifying body founded on a simple observation: project controls has never had a focused professional standard of its own — and AI is changing the work faster than any existing credential covers.

What we offer:

- Three certifications — PCL-AI (project controls), PFL-AI (project finance), PML-AI (project management) — scenario-based, properly proctored exams, framework developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024.
- Membership with CPD tracking, a global chapter network (20+ countries) and free resources — guides, salary reports, a full body of knowledge.
- Everything verifiable: any credential can be checked by anyone at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html.

One honest note, because it's how we operate: we're building toward formal accreditation and say so plainly — we never claim recognition we don't yet hold.

If you'd like to look, start here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/why-pci.html. Any questions, just ask.

A5. DM — honorary invitation

Use when: inviting a distinguished practitioner to apply. This is the highest-value message — send it sparingly and personalise heavily.

[Name], I'll be direct about why I'm writing.

The board of the Project Controls Institute confers a small number of Honorary Fellow (PCI) recognitions on practitioners whose contribution to the profession genuinely merits it. Given your [specific contribution — be precise], I'd like to invite you to put yourself forward for the board's consideration.

What it involves: a ten-minute application and a CV — that's it. There is no fee. Not to apply, not if conferred, not ever.

If the board confers it, you receive a registered award (publicly verifiable at any time), a certificate, and free access to the institute's resources, events and professional community.

One honest note: this is honorary recognition of contribution. It's separate from PCI's examined certifications, which are only ever earned by examination — we keep that line absolute.

The application is here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html — and I'm happy to answer any questions first.

A6. Follow-up DM (one only, ~1 week later)

Use when: no reply to A4 or A5. After this, stop.

Hi [Name] — just floating this back up once in case it got buried. No pressure at all; if the timing's wrong, all good. The short version: [one line — e.g. "free, board-conferred recognition with a verifiable award — ten-minute application"]. Here if useful.

3.B WhatsApp / short text templates

B1. Shortest version (any chat)

Have you seen the Project Controls Institute? New non-profit certification body for project controls / cost engineering, with AI governance built into the standard. Free resources on the site and every credential is publicly verifiable → projectcontrolsinstitute.org

B2. Honorary short version

Worth knowing about: PCI (Project Controls Institute) confers an Honorary Fellow recognition for people with real contribution to the profession — no exam, no fees at all, and the award is publicly verifiable. 10-minute application:

projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html

3.C Email templates

C1. Cold email — short intro

Use when: first contact. Subject: "A professional standard for project controls".

Dear [Name],

I'm [Your name] from the Project Controls Institute (PCI) — an independent, non-profit body building a focused certification standard for project controls, cost engineering and project finance in the AI era.

Given your role at [Company], I thought it worth one short email. In brief: three scenario-based certifications (PCL-AI, PFL-AI, PML-AI), a global chapter network, free professional resources, and every credential publicly verifiable at any time.

If that's of interest, the best two-minute overview is here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/why-pci.html

Happy to answer any questions.

Best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute · hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

C2. Email — the platform in full detail (long)

Use when: they replied with interest, or a warm contact asked "so what exactly is PCI?" Subject: "PCI in detail — as promised".

Dear [Name],

Thank you for the interest — here's the full picture, honestly told.

Who we are. The Project Controls Institute (PCI) is an independent, non-profit certifying body founded in 2025. Our position is simple: project controls — the integrated discipline of planning, cost, risk, forecasting, contracts and project finance — has long lacked a focused professional standard of its own, and AI is transforming the work. AI can draft the schedule and the forecast; the professional must know whether to trust it. Our slogan says it in six words: *"AI proposes. The professional disposes."*

The certifications. PCI awards the AI Project Leadership Certification Suite:

- **PCL-AI** — PCI AI Project Controls Leader
- **PFL-AI** — PCI AI Project Finance Leader
- **PML-AI** — PCI Project Management Leader – AI

The examinations are scenario-based and delivered under proper proctoring through a secure exam system; preparation runs on Certuvo, PCI's official study platform. The certification framework is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024, the international standard for bodies certifying persons.

Membership and community. Membership grades run from Student through Professional to Fellow, with CPD tracking, a professional directory and a chapter network across 20+ countries. The resource library — study guides, white papers, salary reports, a full body of knowledge, and regular webinars — is on the site, much of it free.

Three ways in.

1. **Standard** — enrol, study, sit the exam (membership currently USD [check live site], exam USD [check live site]).

2. **Founding** — during the founding window, fees are waived for the founding cohort; the exam is unchanged and the credential is still earned by passing it.

3. **Honorary** — for distinguished contribution to the profession, the board confers **Honorary Fellow (PCI)**: no exam, and no fees of any kind. It comes with a registered, verifiable award, a certificate, and free access to resources, events and the community. It is always labelled honorary — it is never the examined certification.

Verification. Every credential and honorary award can be checked by anyone, at any time, at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html. We think a claim you can't verify is worth very little.

Our honest position. PCI is building toward formal accreditation and toward non-profit tax-exempt recognition, and we state plainly that neither is held yet. We never guarantee jobs, salaries or third-party recognition. For a certification body, trust is the entire product — so we'd rather understate than oversell.

If you'd like to go further: [choose one — enrolment: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/enrol.html / honorary application: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html / a call this week].

With best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute · hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

C3. Email — honorary invitation (long)

Use when: formally inviting a senior figure. Subject: "An invitation — Honorary Fellow of the Project Controls Institute".

Dear [Name],

I'm writing on behalf of the Project Controls Institute (PCI), an independent non-profit certifying body for project controls, cost engineering and project finance.

Each year the institute's board confers a small number of **Honorary Fellow (PCI)** recognitions on individuals whose sustained contribution to the profession merits it. Your [specific contribution — publications, standards work, programme leadership, mentoring at scale], is precisely the kind of contribution this recognition exists for, and I would like to invite you to put yourself forward for the board's consideration.

What it involves. A short application (about ten minutes) with your CV at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html. You receive a reference immediately, and the board reviews every application personally. **There is no fee at any stage — not to apply, not if conferred, and nothing recurring afterwards.**

What conferral brings.

- The designation Honorary Fellow (PCI), conferred with a citation
- A registered award number, publicly verifiable by anyone at any time
- A certificate issued by the institute
- Free access to PCI's professional resources, webinars and events
- Membership of a growing global community, with chapters in 20+ countries

In fairness, two honest notes. Conferral is at the board's discretion — an invitation to apply is not a promise of the outcome. And Honorary Fellow (PCI) is a recognition of contribution: it is deliberately separate from PCI's examined certifications, which are only ever earned by examination. We keep that distinction absolute, because it protects the value of both.

I would be delighted to answer any questions before you decide.

With respect and best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute · hello@projectcontrolsinstitute.org

C4. Email — employer / corporate (medium)

Use when: writing to HR, PMO or capability leads. Subject: "A consistent standard for project-controls capability".

Dear [Name],

When you hire a planner or cost engineer, how do you know what you're getting? Most organisations answer with interviews and hope — because project controls has never had a single, verifiable standard.

The Project Controls Institute (PCI) is an independent non-profit building exactly that: a certification suite covering project controls, cost engineering and project finance, with the governed use of AI treated as part of the discipline. Scenario-based proctored examinations, a published body of knowledge, and — importantly for employers — **every credential publicly verifiable in seconds** at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html.

For teams, that means a shared capability language across projects and regions, and a development pathway your controls staff can see. Corporate programmes are here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/corporate-programs.html

Would a 20-minute call be useful? I'm happy to walk through how other [sector] organisations are approaching it.

Best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute

C5. Email — university / training provider (medium)

Use when: academic programme leads or training companies. Subject: "Partnering on the project-controls standard".

Dear [Name],

The Project Controls Institute (PCI) is an independent non-profit certifying body for project controls, cost engineering and project finance — with a published body of knowledge and a certification suite (PCL-AI, PFL-AI, PML-AI) developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024.

We partner with [universities: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/university-partnerships.html / training providers: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/become-a-training-partner.html] to connect programmes like yours at [Institution] to a recognised professional pathway: students and delegates study against the PCI body of knowledge, and graduates leave with a route to a verifiable professional credential.

If a conversation would be useful, I'd be glad to set one up.

Best regards,

[Your name] · Project Controls Institute

C6. Follow-up email (one only, ~1 week later)

Dear [Name],

A brief follow-up on my note below — I know inboxes are unforgiving. If it's not for you or not for now, no reply needed and I won't chase again. If it is, the one link worth a look is: [single most relevant link].

Best regards,
[Your name]

3.D Post templates (LinkedIn / newsletter)

D1. Honorary conferral announcement

The board of the Project Controls Institute has conferred **Honorary Fellow (PCI)** on [Name], in recognition of [citation — one concrete sentence].

Honorary Fellow (PCI) is a board-conferred recognition of distinguished contribution to the profession — no examination, and distinct from PCI's examined certifications.

Award [PCI-HON-YYYY-NNNN] · verifiable any time at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html

Congratulations, [Name]. [Tag them.]

#ProjectControls #CostEngineering #ProjectManagement

D2. "What is PCI" post (personal voice)

People keep asking what the Project Controls Institute actually is, so — plainly:

An independent, non-profit certification body for project controls, cost engineering and project finance. Three scenario-based certifications (PCL-AI, PFL-AI, PML-AI). A body of knowledge you can read. Proctored exams you can't shortcut. Credentials anyone can verify online, any time.

And one thing we don't do: overclaim. We're building toward accreditation and we say exactly where we are. In a market full of certificate mills, we think honesty is the differentiator.

Start here: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/why-pci.html

#ProjectControls #CostEngineering #PlanningEngineer

D3. Honorary route awareness post

Some people have already given this profession more than any exam could measure.

That's what the honorary route is for. The Project Controls Institute board confers **Honorary Fellow (PCI)** on practitioners of distinguished contribution — no examination, **no fees of any kind**, and a registered award anyone can verify online.

It's not our examined certification and it never pretends to be. It's recognition — real, registered and free.

Apply for the board's consideration: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/honorary-application.html

#ProjectControls #CostEngineering #ProjectManagement

3.E Quick replies to common questions

"Is PCI accredited?"

Honest answer: not yet, and we won't pretend otherwise. The framework is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 and we're building toward formal accreditation — the site states our exact status at projectcontrolsinstitute.org/accreditation-status.html.

"What does it cost?"

The standard route: membership plus the exam fee (current prices are on projectcontrolsinstitute.org/membership.html — there are launch discounts running). The honorary route costs nothing at all — no application, conferral or renewal fees.

"What's the difference between Honorary Fellow and the certification?"

Certifications (PCL-AI, PFL-AI, PML-AI) are earned only by passing a proctored exam. Honorary Fellow (PCI) is the board recognising distinguished contribution — no exam, always labelled honorary, never presented as the examined credential. Both are publicly verifiable.

"How is this different from PMP or AACE?"

We don't claim equivalence with anyone. The difference in scope: PCI certifies the whole controls discipline as one integrated capability — planning, cost, risk, finance — with governed AI use treated as core, not an add-on. Comparison page:

projectcontrolsinstitute.org/pmp-vs-aace-vs-pcl-ai.html.

"How do I check someone's PCI credential?"

Anyone can, free, in seconds: projectcontrolsinstitute.org/verify.html — enter the credential or award number.

Part 4 — Do / Don't (the guardrails)

Do say: developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 · building toward accreditation · independent non-profit institute · publicly verifiable · free, board-conferred honorary recognition · no fees on the honorary route.

Never say: accredited / ISO-certified / government-recognised · 501(c)(3) or tax-deductible · guaranteed jobs, salary or recognition by employers · anything implying Honorary Fellow is a certification or a waived exam · guaranteed conferral ("apply and you'll receive...").

Behaviour: one follow-up maximum, then stop · never blast groups or buy lists · get permission before naming an awardee in a post · when unsure, use the site footer's own wording — it's the approved formulation.